but as a motivation for intensive dialogue, mutual appreciation and enrichment.

Overall, we have been able to achieve fairly good results, to start a transition from confrontation to a policy of accommodation. And this is, probably, not just a result of a frank and constructive personal relationship, although obviously personal rapport is not the least important thing in politics. Paraphrasing a favorite phrase of yours, I would say that talking to each other, people learn more about each other.

And yet, the main thing that made our common new policy a success is, above all, the fact that it reflects a gradually emerging balance of national interests, which we have been able in some measure to implement. We feel, in particular, that it is favorable to the development of new approaches, of new political thinking, first of all in our two countries—but also elsewhere. The experience of even the past few months indicates that increasing numbers of third world countries are beginning to readjust to our positive interactions, associating with it their interest and policies.

Ironic as it may sound, it is our view that the strength of what we have been able to accomplish owes quite a lot to how hard it was to do.

It is probably not by a mere chance that the jointly devised general course in the development of Soviet-U.S. relations is now enjoying broad based support in our two countries. So far, as we know, both of your possible successors support, among other things, the key objectives of concluding a treaty on 50 per cent cutbacks in Soviet and U.S. strategic arsenals. In the Soviet leadership, too, there is a consensus on this. And yet, it has not been possible to bring the Geneva negotiations to fruition, a fact about which I feel some